

1. Empowering the "Connected Worker" at the Edge

- **How might we** empower frontline factory operators with reliable, secure digital tools to drive the "Digital Lean" initiative toward zero loss?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Deploy immutable OS appliances directly to manufacturing plant floors to ensure zero-downtime access to training, generative AI guidance, and real-time operational data 1, 2.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) using Image Mode (Bootc) 1.

2. Automating IT Remediation for the AAA Initiative

- **How might we** accelerate the Advancing Agility & Automation (AAA) Initiative's \$300 million cost-saving mandate by eliminating manual IT troubleshooting 3?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Integrate Hershey's existing Dynatrace observability tool with ServiceNow to automatically trigger remediation playbooks (such as adding an F5 load balancer node) and close tickets without human intervention 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Ansible Automation Platform (specifically Event-Driven Ansible) 1.

3. Scaling the Agentic AI Marketing Mix

- **How might we** seamlessly scale Hershey's real-time, agentic AI marketing mix models across their multi-cloud environment to optimize advertising spend overnight 4, 5?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Provide a unified, portable container platform that allows Hershey to orchestrate and deploy their proprietary marketing AI models seamlessly across AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud 6, 7.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift AI 7.

4. Consolidating the OpenShift Fleet

- **How might we** reduce the hardware and management infrastructure bloat caused by Hershey's 12 resource-heavy MuleSoft clusters 1?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Consolidate the current fleet down to roughly 4 clusters (Non-prod, Prod East, Prod West) utilizing hosted control planes to drastically reduce the computing cores required for worker nodes 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Advanced Cluster Management (ACM) 1.

5. Eradicating Legacy Oracle Technical Debt

- **How might we** safely migrate Hershey off aging SPARC hardware while avoiding exorbitant full-cluster virtualization licensing costs for Oracle 1?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Containerize and strictly fence off Oracle compute resources on a dedicated cluster, bypassing the need to license all 4,000 cores in a traditional Nutanix virtualized environment 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift 1.

6. Modernizing the Microsoft SQL Footprint

- **How might we** efficiently manage and modernize Hershey's massive legacy database footprint 1?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Implement a modern Database-as-a-Service (DBaaS) architecture to host and consolidate their 4,000 Microsoft SQL Server databases in a scalable, containerized environment 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift 1.

7. Safeguarding the SAP S/4HANA "Clean Core"

- **How might we** ensure maximum stability and zero-downtime operations for the newly unified ERP backbone that now runs 95% of Hershey's global business 8, 9?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Standardize the underlying operating system for their mission-critical SAP workloads across cloud providers, implementing proactive monitoring to remediate misconfigurations before they cause outages 10.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** RHEL for SAP Solutions with Red Hat Insights 10.

8. Enhancing the "Agnes" Autonomous IVR System

- **How might we** improve the reliability and scalability of the "Agnes" AI agent managing over 50% of routine IT password resets and HR call-offs 11, 12?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Host the backend microservices and APIs that integrate Agnes with Hershey's internal tech stack in a highly available, auto-scaling container environment 6, 12.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift 6.

9. Automating EUDR Supply Chain Traceability

- **How might we** streamline the massive data collection required for Hershey to prove deforestation-free cocoa sourcing ahead of the December 2026 EUDR deadline 13?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Automate the extraction, configuration, and monitoring of GPS polygon mapping and traceability data streams from supply chain partners into Digital Product Passports 13, 14.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Ansible Automation Platform 14.

10. Empowering the Global Capability Center (GCC)

- **How might we** accelerate the onboarding, training, and productivity of developers in Hershey's Global Capability Center 1?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Deploy a specialized AI assistant directly into the developer workflow to help them write operational code, manage clusters, and troubleshoot deployments securely 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** OpenShift Lightspeed 1.

11. Supercharging Kinaxis Decision Intelligence

- **How might we** support Hershey's supply chain demand-planning software in achieving its target of a \$100 million inventory reduction 15, 16?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Provide an elastic, high-performance compute layer that allows machine learning algorithms to process massive retail signals and adjust manufacturing schedules in real time 17.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift 6.

12. Bridging Multi-Cloud Infrastructure as Code (IaC)

- **How might we** unify infrastructure provisioning across Hershey's complex AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud footprint 18?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Combine the power of HashiCorp Terraform for foundational cloud provisioning with automated application configuration and middleware deployment to speed up time-to-market for new services 19, 20.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Ansible Automation Platform 20.

13. Unifying the "ONE Hershey" Data Integration

- **How might we** ensure seamless real-time data integration to support cross-category promotions between the newly consolidated sweet, salty, and protein divisions 21, 22?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Create a highly resilient, container-based integration layer that ensures MuleSoft APIs can securely and reliably broker data between formerly siloed business units 1.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift 1.

14. Enabling AI-Driven Quality Control on the Factory Floor

- **How might we** bring proactive AI anomaly detection directly to the salty snack and confection production lines 23?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Deploy lightweight, small-footprint Kubernetes nodes on the factory floor to run computer vision and predictive maintenance models locally, bypassing the latency of cloud round-trips 24, 25.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat Device Edge (featuring MicroShift) 24, 26.

15. Modernizing Legacy Applications Smoothly

- **How might we** help Hershey efficiently modernize its 176 disparate legacy applications without requiring complete application rewrites 6?
- **Concrete Action/Project:** Utilize a "build once, deploy anywhere" platform that allows Hershey to run both traditional virtual machine workloads alongside modern containerized microservices in a single, unified environment 6, 27.
- **Primary Red Hat Technology:** Red Hat OpenShift Virtualization 27.